
Dale Carnegie Communication Excellence

Participant Manual





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Dale Carnegie

Communication Excellence

At the completion of this program, participants will be able to:

1. Know how to assess the audience
2. Learn how to use correct language & write for impact
3. Know non-verbal factors
4. Communicate for various results
5. Practice listening
6. Plan and prepare effectively to conduct engaging, productive, online meetings

Module 1

Know Your Audience

At the completion of this module, participants will be able to:

- Understand the importance of knowing the audience
- Know pitfalls of not knowing the audience
- Know your learning style
- Know what to do to communicate with others who have different learning styles

The Audience

Ask yourself ...

If you had to communicate with the other participants in this seminar about a topic in your line of work, and be effective, would you know:

	Yes	No
what they <i>need</i> to know	☐	☐
what they <i>want</i> to know	☐	☐
why they are here	☐	☐
if they are here because they want to be here or under orders	☐	☐
their education levels	☐	☐
what levels they occupy in their companies	☐	☐
if they have any previous experience about your profession or topic	☐	☐
if they are used to receiving written or verbal communication	☐	☐
what type of communication they prefer	☐	☐
if they will respond to facts and figures	☐	☐
if they like visual presentation styles	☐	☐
if they like to be involved in the communication	☐	☐
their opinion about PowerPoint presentations	☐	☐
if they like documents or handouts of any communication	☐	☐
if they will want to listen	☐	☐
if they expect entertainment	☐	☐
if they want you to remain serious	☐	☐
their likely attitude about your topic or profession	☐	☐
what questions they might have about your topic or presentation	☐	☐
what they would do with any information you would give them	☐	☐
how they will generally respond if you ask them to do something	☐	☐
how they learn new things	☐	☐
how they will respond to humour	☐	☐
how they will respond to how you are dressed	☐	☐

Why it's important to know your audience:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

Some of the pitfalls of not knowing your audience include:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

Elements to Consider

Who Is My Audience?

It is as difficult to satisfy the unknown expectations of an audience as it is to hit an unseen target. It can be done, but it is a chancy way to seek success. Part of the process of preparation is the research that gathers the following information about the audience.

Knowledge—The most obvious consideration about the knowledge level of the audience that concerns most presenters is: “Is the audience better informed than I am?” This is probably the less serious of the presenter’s concerns because the concern itself will stimulate adequate preparation. Therefore, the greater problem is the danger of assuming the knowledge level of the audience. Never face an audience unprepared, but also never fall into the trap of assuming listener ignorance and talking down to the audience.

Expertise—The skill level of the audience is also important because that may determine the position on the issue that you want to take.

Experience—This consideration is not only how much experience the audience has, but at what level and in what environment. Experience in a laboratory is significantly different than experience in the field.

Prejudice—If you can identify the prejudices of the audience, you can ascertain where they are starting from and some of the pitfalls you will need to avoid.

Needs—In order to send the listeners home with a sense of satisfaction and feeling glad they were there, it is wise to address their needs. Theory is important when building evidence but eventually you must “get the hay down out of the loft so the horses can eat it.”

Wants—Similar to needs are the audience’s wants. Wants and needs are not always the same, and if you only address needs, it is difficult to satisfy an audience and move them to action.

Goals—Determine the goals of your audience and keep them in mind as you plan your communication.

Learning Style Survey

There has been much written on learning styles, or, people's preferences for the way they work with information. This information is especially important for educators, teachers, and students. It is equally important for managers, as it will help in determining how to present or communicate information to your listener.

Here's a survey to help determine your learning style:

	Often	Sometimes	Seldom
1. I like to use maps to find my way	☐	☐	☐
2. It's easier for me to follow verbal directions	☐	☐	☐
3. I listen to motivational tapes in the car	☐	☐	☐
4. It's easy for me to shake hands with others	☐	☐	☐
5. I'm always fooling with a pencil or pen when listening	☐	☐	☐
6. I like to read to find out about new things	☐	☐	☐
7. I say things out loud in order to remember them	☐	☐	☐
8. I like news on the radio over reading the newspaper	☐	☐	☐
9. I like reading a newspaper over hearing it on radio	☐	☐	☐
10. I write things down when someone is telling me something	☐	☐	☐
11. I use models, demonstrations, and posters when explaining things	☐	☐	☐
12. I love to solve puzzles	☐	☐	☐
13. It's easy for me to picture things when I hear them	☐	☐	☐
14. I use lots of gestures when describing things to others	☐	☐	☐
15. I'd rather listen to a lecture than read about it	☐	☐	☐
16. I write notes so that I can visually review them later	☐	☐	☐
17. I have better recall when I write things down many times	☐	☐	☐
18. It helps me to see diagrams, graphs, or slides	☐	☐	☐
19. I like to make things	☐	☐	☐
20. It's easy for me to hear musical pitch and harmony	☐	☐	☐
21. I like to make my own graphs, charts, and slides	☐	☐	☐

Learning Style Survey Scoring

From the previous page, place the point value in the box next to the corresponding question number. Add the points in each column to find your preference score under “Visual,” “Auditory,” and “Kinesthetic.”

Score 5 for “Often”

Score 3 for “Sometimes”

Score 1 for “Seldom”

Visual		Auditory		Kinesthetic	
Question	Points	Question	Points	Question	Points
1		2		4	
6		3		5	
9		7		10	
12		8		11	
13		15		14	
16		18		17	
21		20		19	
Total Visual		Total Auditory		Total Kinesthetic	

I am primarily a _____ learner.

Total Visual in the group: _____

Total Auditory in the group: _____

Total Kinesthetic in the group: _____

Learning Style Preferences

Visual

- Learns primarily by seeing
- Likes charts, maps, slides, movies, videos, pictures, diagrams, symbols
- Likes color
- Benefits from handouts for visual review
- Wants to see you demonstrate it
- _____
- _____
- _____

Auditory

- Would like to have a tape of your communication to review
- Learns by engaging in two-way conversation
- Likes lecture
- Likes group discussion
- Likes stories
- _____
- _____
- _____

Kinesthetic

- Likes “hands on” activity
 - Likes demonstrations
 - Takes notes
 - Needs handouts with space to write
 - _____
 - _____
 - _____
-

Audiences with Multiple Learning Styles

- Make sure communication has equal mix of all three styles
- Break up timing of communication so that no style dominates for too long
- Use summaries often (auditory)
- Use visual representations of major points vs. “text bullets” (visual)
- Allow for questions & answers (auditory & kinesthetic)
- Provide pictures in handouts (visual)
- Provide handouts with space to take notes (visual & kinesthetic)
- Have a variety of visual aids—charts, pictures, video (visual)
- Repeat major theme points often (auditory)
- Ask for the listener to repeat directions (auditory & kinesthetic)

Other things to include for visual learners:

Other things to include for auditory learners:

Other things to include for kinesthetic learners:

When I communicate with others, I generally neglect the

_____ learning style(s).

What I will do to improve my communications in the future:

[illegible]

[illegible]

Module 2

Selecting the Correct Language

At the completion of this module, participants will be able to:

- Learn to consider other's points of view before communicating
- Learn basics of using appropriate language
- Practice keeping communications simple
- Learn to use the active voice
- Practice communicating benefits
- Learn and practice the power of using analogies
- Know words or phrases that invoke negative emotion

Their Point of View

In his book *How to Win Friends and Influence People*, which continues to sell millions of copies since it's publication in 1936, and was named the Business Book of the 20th Century by Business Life magazine, Dale Carnegie says:

If out of reading this book you get just one thing—an increased tendency to think always in terms of the other people’s point of view, and see things from their angle—if you get that one thing out of this book, it may easily prove to be one of the building blocks of your career.

People occupy different positions in companies and have different objectives. They often have different vocabularies, based on the type of work they do.

Without meaning to stereotype, what might be some “business-issue words” or phrases that these professionals might use on a day-to-day basis? (For example, a CEO might use “market share” on a daily or at least weekly basis.)

CEO of a Fortune 500 Company:

Bank Manager for a local branch office:

Marketing Manager for a Mid-sized Company:

Line Manager at a Manufacturing Plant:

Sales Manager for a Small Company of less than 100 employees:

Chief Financial Officer for a Mid-sized Company:

[illegible]

Use Appropriate Language

Watch out for “specialist” language—don’t use “jargon:”

Keep words and phrases simple:

Make sure the language is familiar to the audience:

Use active words and phrases, rather than passive:

Use real examples and analogies instead of the abstract:

Notes

Keep It Simple

What single word might be used in place of these “wordy” expressions?

In place of ...	Substitute
At this point in time	_____
On the occasion of	_____
As a result of	_____
On the grounds that	_____
In spite of the fact that	_____
Subsequent to	_____
In the event that	_____
The question as to whether	_____
Is of the opinion of	_____
After very careful consideration	_____
Reach a conclusion as to	_____
Is of the opinion that	_____

Others

Active vs. Passive

The active voice sells. It is more direct. It has energy. Consider these two sentences:

PASSIVE “The training was taken by many employees of the company.”

The subject, “training,” is acted upon. Training was taken. The sentence is passive.

ACTIVE “Everyone in XYZ Company takes training to improve their skills.”

The subject acts. Everyone takes training. It is active.

Use the active voice when communicating—it has passion, momentum, and force. It commands action. Generally, the active voice is easier to understand and less complicated. Use it.

Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Communicate Benefits

When communicating to get action from others, consider that they will always be asking “What’s in it for me?”—although they may never speak those words. Also, adults want to know “why” they are being asked to do something. Managers must get action in their roles within companies. To get action, think “benefit”—from their point of view.

Things or services that your company provides:

Benefit derived by customers from using your products or services:

[illegible]

Notes

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 20 evenly spaced horizontal grey lines across its entire width, providing a template for writing or drawing. The margins are consistent on all sides.

Make the Language Relate—Use Analogies

Using analogies provides the audience with a reference for understanding abstract ideas. When they don't have experience with a subject, we must help them connect the unknown of our ideas with the known of their experience.

Analogy:

Rules for using analogies:

- It must be one that all of your audience is likely to encounter (brushing of teeth, driving a car, eating lunch)
- It should be short
- It must be simple to explain and quickly understood
- It should relate to the specific audience—it should come from their frame of reference
- It must make the unknown more clear—not the opposite! (If the analogy is complex, the unknown becomes even more complex!)
- State the unfamiliar, then connect it to the familiar

- ---
- ---
- ---
- ---

Analogy Format:

“A is to B as C is to D”

Examples:

- Adding ingredients of this chemical formula is like spelling a word—there are only a few ingredients to pick from and they must be added in a precise order or you will end up with a totally different result.
- Trying to sell while ignoring past successes and failures is like bowling under a curtain hung across the alley—we don’t know how well we have done and where to throw the next ball.
- A skilled presenter is like a swan out on a calm lake—the appearance is that everything is perfectly under control, while under the water, the feet are churning to move forward.

How to construct analogies:

1. Determine key points to explain
2. Select the main concept that must be understood
3. Select some unrelated concepts that you can use to the main concept
4. Check to insure that all of the audience will understand the unrelated concept
5. Develop the analogy
6. Test the analogy with a few people who would not know of the complex or unknown subject matter that is to be explained—see if they understand the new concept quickly through the use of the analogy

Develop an analogy for a business concept, product, or service that your company provides which may not be familiar to others:

Words or Phrases That Invoke Negative Emotions

Sometimes managers use certain language that should be avoided if enthusiastic action is the desired result.

Match the phrase on the left with the Human Relations Principle that has been overlooked on the right.

“I want you to ...”

“I hear what you’re saying, but ...”

“You’re wrong.”

“Let me tell you what I think ...”

Make the other person feel important—and do it sincerely.

Show respect for the other person's opinion. Never tell a person he or she is wrong.

Let the other person feel the idea is his or hers.

Ask questions instead of giving direct orders.

Notes

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[illegible]

[illegible]

Module 3

Writing for Impact

At the completion of this module, participants will be able to:

- Understand the importance of communicating from the audience's point of view
- Learn two methods of opening written communications
- Learn seven ways to provide evidence
- Learn eight ways to close a communication to leave a lasting impression
- Practice writing and learn from feedback

Writing from the Audience's Point of View

From: john_smith@xyz.company
To: marydoe@abc.company
Subject: XYZ Delivers!!

Dear Mary Doe,

I'm glad that we got together and that I was able to show you how our company can provide the service that will ultimately show you what others have been saying about us for a long time, "XYZ Delivers."

I hope that I was able to cover all of the services we have available and that you will call on us soon for a project.

You can call me at 222-222-2222 anytime. I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,
John Smith

What's wrong with the above email?

[illegible]

Opening the Communication—Grabbing Attention

Opening any communication is difficult—the audience or other person is generally thinking about something entirely different from what you are about to say. You must get their immediate and favorable attention. Here are some considerations:

Begin with a question. It involves the audience immediately.	Make a statement that startles the audience (in a favorable way).
• “Isn’t it time we ...” • “Are you intrigued by ...” • “Did you know that ...” • “Did you ever ask yourself ...”	• “I will be changing your mind about ...” • “You will now be convinced that ...” • “Forget everything you’ve ever heard about ...” • “Believe it or not ...” • “Today, more than ever ...”

Notes

[illegible]

The Heart of Communication—Using Evidence

Once attention of the audience/reader is established, one way to keep attention and interest is to provide specific facts and evidence to reduce doubt.

They may be thinking to themselves:

- Why should I believe you?
- Why should I listen to you?
- Who, besides you, says so?
- How does this affect me?
- What is in it for me?
- How would this work for me?
- How do you mean?

Remember that “Evidence DEFEATS Doubt.” There are a number of ways to provide specific evidence:

D emonstration	Show or describe how something works
E xperience	Give your own or other people’s examples/incidents
F acts	Provide information that is specific, concrete, true, and verifiable
E xhibits	Show or include a graph, picture, drawing, map, object, or slide
A nalogies	Make a comparison to something the listener is familiar with
T estimonials	Quote someone of authority who is respected by the listener
S tatistics	Provide numerical comparisons, percentages, trends

When communicating, be specific. What can be done to make the following more specific?

“Our company has been around for a long time.”

“This department has a reputation for getting things done.”

“I know that you will be able to accomplish this task.”

“I expect that this will be completed in due course.”

Summarize in a few words	Examples “In summary, the key points to remember are ...” • “... therefore, the action we need to take is ...”
Appeal to the nobler motives	“In the interest of the company” • “For a better society” • “To decrease famine” • “Your contribution can save lives”
Throw down a challenge	“It is up to you” • “You are the only ones who can realize these goals”
Dramatise your ideas	A slide showing the final project • A picture that indicates the team’s progress • A token or lapel pin that is distributed to the audience
Repeat the most important point	“... we will see our goals realized” • “... your income will be increased by X%” • “... we will treat you to an unforgettable evening”
Use a motivating statement	“No more financial worries” • “Imagine your children happy, healthy, and safe” • “You can have an extra hour with your family every day”
Use a quotation	Use direct quotes that are relevant • Be familiar with whom you are quoting
Speak on a personal level	“As Susan and Betsy have demonstrated, we can achieve this level of performance” • “If we, as a team, follow Tom and John’s example, we will realize our goals”

Writing Practice

Write a short note to the participants in your group. The intent is to thank them for working with you and to inform them of your company/department—to give them additional information that they might remember you and your company, product, or services.

Remember to:

- Consider the audience/group—their needs, wants, etc.
- Use language that will appeal to their level
- Keep it simple
- Use the “active voice” whenever possible
- State facts with accompanying evidence
- Try an analogy
- Grab their attention with your opening—be creative
- Use evidence
- Provide a close that leaves a positive, lasting impression of you and your company/product/services

Notes

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

[illegible]

[illegible][illegible]

[illegible]

Module 4

Saying More with Less

At the completion of this module, participants will be able to:

- Create e-mails that stop the click through
- Use bullets to say more
- Explore the exception to all rules

E-mail

Etiquette Violation:

[illegible]

Notes

[illegible]

E-mail Etiquette

Surveys have shown that email is the #1 reason most people use the Internet. Email can broadcast thousands of messages quickly, efficiently, effectively and much cheaper than any other traditional media. In addition, email messages you send can easily be forwarded on to other colleagues, family and friends, making your clients advocates for your business. By adhering to some basic guidelines, you can help ensure that your email is both received and read by your customers. Any violation of these rules can result in your emails being blocked by a recipient's company.

To improve the impact of your messages and avoid trouble, there are a few unwritten rules, called etiquette, you should be aware of:

- Clearly **summarize your message** in the subject line. Your subject line must be clear, honest, and not misleading.
- Keep your messages **short and focused**. Recipients tend to ignore long messages. If it takes longer than three to five minutes to write a message, think about phoning or arranging a meeting with this person.
- Don't write in all **CAPITAL LETTERS**. Capital letters are used for emphasis, and are considered equivalent to **SHOUTING**.
- Don't write anything you wouldn't say in public. It is easy for the recipients to forward it to others, which could leave you in an embarrassing position if you divulge personal or confidential information.
- Mean what you write. Email can be saved, printed, archived, copied, misrouted, forwarded, and opened by total strangers. Remember, your message may be read by someone you did not originally intend to receive it.
- At the bottom of your email, include:
 - your name.
 - contact information: email address, organization's name, street address, phone number.
 - opportunity for the recipient to unsubscribe from receiving email in the future.
An example would be: "To unsubscribe from this email list, please reply with Unsubscribe in the subject line."
- Please proofread your email for grammar and spelling errors before sending it out. A professional looking email will garner more interest.
- When sending a mass-email, all of your recipients' email addresses must go in the bcc (blind cc) field.

Always be polite and professional. You're not only representing your business, but your entire organization.

E-mail Summary Format

To: Y900 Project Team

CC: Managing Directors

Subject: Action steps for Y900 product launch

Summary: There is consensus from the team that the revision of this product is critical to our long-term international success in penetrating new markets.

- The investment of \$450,000 for this revision will pay for itself in 14 months.
- Target completion date is August, 2003.
- Significant communication will be required to sell this to our distributors.

All directors have endorsed this initiative and have established specific action steps:

Marketing: Terry Gleason has determined that his department will ...

Production: Chris Korner will research the production costs and ...

North America: Sandy Baker will launch testing on January 15 ...

Latin America: Geraldo Suarez will begin translation of the written materials and ...

Europe: Mathais Bonnemark determined that the different formats will require ...

Asia/Pacific: Soen Boek will begin on-site meetings with regional managers ...

Bullets or Parallel Structure

Often an interesting idea may take the form of a list. When a sentence contains a list, that list must be made up of identical grammatical elements. In other words, it must be parallel. A parallel list can be made up of all nouns, all verbs, all complete sentences, or all fragments. Consistency is the key.

Example: All grocery lists are parallel.

Apples

Oranges

Pears

Ice cream

Bread

Skim milk

Cookies

Lists can be vertical or horizontal. Often we read horizontal lists and don't even notice they are lists.

Example: I want to **race** to work, **get** my project done, **start** the proposal, and **have** lunch with Terry.

Notes

Parallel Exercise

Make these lists parallel.

1. We are interested in boosting employee morale, balancing the budget, and outperform the competition.
2. Leaders should be able to:
 - Listen effectively
 - Watch for potential problems
 - Delegate responsibility
 - Respect differences of opinion
 - Composure at all times
3. The computer comes with Internet software, desktop publishing, and scanning software.
4. A superfan's duty is to wear a rainbow wig and yelling at the referees.
5. A commercial should be informative and of interest.
6. A Big Mac includes:
 - Two all-beef patties
 - Special sauce
 - Lettuce
 - Cheese
 - Pickles
 - Onions
 - On a sesame seed bun
7. The rookie pitched an uneven game, allowing only three hits but he walked seven batters.

[illegible]

Tips on Word Usage

1. Who and Whom

“Who” is more *active* than “whom.” It is the subject (doer) of an action.

- I do not know **who can help me**.

This bolded word group is the object of ‘know,’ but there is action within the object.

“Whom” is always an *object* alone. It is always a bystander, doing nothing. It is passive.

- I do not know **whom** to criticise.
- To **whom** do you wish to speak?
- Do you know **who she is**?
- I know **whom** he was talking about.

Try a few:

1. As a leader, he ranks with Roosevelt, (who/whom) many business people revere.
2. Do you know (who/whom) it was that called?
3. There is no doubt about (who/whom) was the most effective manager.
4. You’ll never guess (who/whom) I saw this morning!
5. I’ve heard that the manager (who/whom) you like is a pain!

2. Affect and Effect

3. Lie and Lay

4. Except vs. Accept

5. Other confusing words

Its

It's

Your

You're

There

Their

Follow-up

Follow up

Toward (US)

Towards (UK)

Ensure

Insure

Assure

Notes

[illegible]

Dangling Modifiers

A haunted sentence contains a phrase that alludes to (or describes) a person or thing that *mysteriously* never appears in the sentence.

Examples:

1. Laughing and joking around the big black pot, the stew bubbled.
(Perhaps some witches were standing around laughing and joking ... but we can't be sure. It certainly wasn't the stew.)
2. After adjusting for inflation, salaries were raised.
(Salaries can't adjust for inflation. Employers can. Where are they in the sentence?)
3. When comparing paper planners to electronic planners, paper planners win.
(Who is making this comparison? The person with the discriminating taste is missing.)

These adjective phrases are modifying an *invisible ghost*. To correct this problem, you need to put the ghost into the sentence or cut the phrase entirely and rewrite.

- 3a. When comparing paper planners to electronic planners, **my boss Terri said that** paper planners are better.
- 3b. Paper planners are better than electronic planners.

Notes

Common Mistakes

Run-On Sentences

When two or more independent clauses (a word group that can stand alone as a sentence) appear in one sentence, they need to be joined in one of two ways:

- With a comma and a coordinating conjunction (and, but, or, nor, for, so, yet).
- With a semicolon.

If two independent clauses are joined without these connectives, then we get something like this:

- “Gestures are a means of communication for everyone, they are essential for the hearing impaired.”
- “Gestures are a means of communication for everyone they are essential for the hearing impaired.”

Use the proper connectives:

- “Gestures are a means of communication for everyone, and they are essential for the hearing impaired.”
- “Gestures are a means of communication for everyone; they are essential for the hearing impaired.”

Sentence Fragments

A piece of a sentence is not a sentence. You need a subject and verb for an independent clause, but if it begins with a subordinating word, then you still have a fragment:

- “If she is elected special student adviser.”—This is not a sentence. But,
- “Jane will address the problem if she is elected special student adviser.” is a sentence.

“Mary is suffering from agoraphobia. A fear of the outside world.”

Needs:

“Mary is suffering from agoraphobia, a fear of the outside world.”

[illegible]

Module 5

The Listening Challenge

At the completion of this module, participants will be able to:

- Understand the complexity of communication
- Identify some of the obstacles to better listening
- Learn the value of listening to learn
- Practice listening skill development
- Commit to improving listening skills

The Communications Dilemma

Person “A” Speaking

Has attitude towards Person B

Has attitude towards subject

Has external stress, pressures

Has cultural sensitivity
(or lack of)

Has thought about
what to say

Translates thought
into language

Selects specific
words & phrases

Emphasizes specific points

Says certain points with no
inflection

Says other points with incongruent
inflection

Within external visual, kinesthetic
& aural “noise” of environment

Doesn’t have good listening skills

May or may not have interest in a
response from “B,” or expects a
specific response

Can’t wait to respond

Doesn’t understand some of the
words use used by Person “A”

Interprets portions of Person “A”’s
communication incorrectly

Momentarily thinks about another
subject

Isn’t skilled at reading non-verbal
communication

Doesn’t understand some of Person
“A”’s communication

Is affected by external visual,
kinesthetic & aural “noise” of
environment

Hears, but does not listen

Loses track of what Person
“A” is saying

Thinks about emphasizing
specific points

Selects specific words & phrases

Translates thought into language

Has thought about what to say—while
Person “A” is speaking

Doesn’t have good listening skills

Has cultural sensitivity (or lack of)

Has external stress, pressures

Has attitude towards subject

Has attitude towards Person “A”

Person “B” Listening

[illegible]

Listening Behaviors

The Four Levels of Listening

1. Ignore completely
2. Pretend to listen
3. Listen selectively
4. Listen attentively/empathetically

Notes

REALLY Listening

R	Regular listening is an event in your daily schedule.
E	Expect that you are accountable for listening.
A	Adopt a want-to-listen attitude.
L	Let others talk—ask questions.
L	Learn something from every listening experience.
Y	You act on what you hear to gain trust.

[illegible]

The Listening LADDER

L	Look at the other person
A	Ask questions
D	Don't interrupt
D	Don't change the subject
E	Express emotion with control
R	Respond appropriately

Notes

Listening Commitment

A person to whom I need to listen more effectively:

Listening behaviors I will practice:

My ability as a manager will be enhanced by:

This communication will occur:

[illegible]

Module 6

Non-Verbal Communication

At the completion of this module, participants will be able to:

- Learn the importance of non-verbal communication
- Learn guidelines for communicating non-verbally one-on-one
- Know how to read the non-verbal communication of others when communicating one-on-one
- Learn guidelines for non-verbal communication when speaking to an audience or a group
- Know how to read the non-verbal communication of an audience

Non-Verbal Communication—One-on-One

List things that people do that send negative messages when communicating one-on-one:

Guidelines for One-on-One Non-Verbal Communication:

Eye Contact:

Handshake/Other Touching:

Smiling:

Gestures:

Notes

Reading the Non-Verbal Communication of Others When One-on-One

What are signs that someone you are communicating with:

Is Not Listening: _____

Does Not Understand: _____

Is Indifferent: _____

Is Hostile: _____

Is Approving: _____

Wants Additional Information: _____

Agrees with You: _____

Non-Verbal Communication — Groups

List things that people do that send negative messages when communicating to groups or audiences:

Guidelines for Non-Verbal Communication (Groups or Audiences):

Eye Contact:

Smiling:

Posture:

Head Movements:

**Gestures/
Movement:**

Reading the Non-Verbal Communication of Audiences or Groups

What are signs that someone you are communicating with:

Is Bored:

Needs Additional Information:

Does Not Agree:

Needs a Break:

Likes What You Are Communicating:

Wants to Act, Wants Additional Information:

Notes

[illegible]

Module 7

Virtual Meetings that Engage

At the completion of this module, participants will be able to:

- Plan and prepare effectively to conduct engaging, productive, online meetings
- Employ engaging meeting techniques and activities
- Analyze virtual meeting activities to adapt for your own use
- Maximize the value of the technologies used during an online meeting
- Incorporate one or more best practices for running virtual meetings

Introduction

When you lead or attend a virtual meeting do you feel engaged in the topic? Do you sometimes wish you could be somewhere else? Virtual meetings don't have to be boring with attendees hiding in the background, checking email, and multitasking. Fortunately, technology has made it easy to run virtual meetings efficiently, and boost collaboration and productivity – that is, if we prepare well and learn the tools available to help us engage our meeting participants. Many organizations have integrated teleconferencing or virtual meetings into normal operations, because their staffs are often spread out in multiple locations. Today, it is more commonplace to have at least a few remote, even global, team members. To make these virtual meetings work, we need planning guidelines that acknowledge and engage the remote members of our teams.

In this 2-hour session, you'll learn to use activities to energize your next online meeting and identify what's unique about preparing for and running an online meeting. Find out what will make it an interactive experience. Explore the answers to these questions: How will you generate participation and build cooperation? What activities will keep your team members engaged? What online tools will help you stay focused and on time? Giving thought to appropriate activities and energizers that work online matters!

This session offers three components of an effective online meeting leadership strategy: pre-meeting planning, managing the meeting, and post-meeting follow-up. You'll participate in and examine meeting activities and online tools used to make your meetings energizing.

Online Meetings—What's Involved?

What is it like to run an online meeting?

What are the challenges?

Pre-Meeting Considerations

- Clarify the purpose (subject line)
- Create meeting room (link), clarify room is ready, have slides loaded
- Plan activities and types of engagement
- Invite attendees by email; provide link, duration, and audio details
- Anticipate and plan for potential questions and resistance
- Prepare and distribute an agenda before the meeting
- Open meeting early to get ready

Meeting Leadership Strategies

- Start and end on time
- Begin with inspiration or on a light-hearted note
- Ask for a volunteer note taker, and keep the meeting moving
- Open with the meeting purpose and time frame
- Clarify the key issues and goals
- Encourage an open and casual environment
- Encourage participation from everyone
- Discuss only one issue at a time and practice good listening skills
- Avoid interrupting other speakers
- List important topics that should be discussed at a later time
- Make frequent summaries of discussion
- Ask questions and show appreciation for everyone's input; express your ideas last
- Show respect for the opinions of others and disagree in an agreeable way
- Support differing opinions and solutions with evidence.
- Assign an individual or team action items; ensure accountability

Technical Details

There are many technical details that can impact the effectiveness of our virtual meeting.

Phone? Computer? Headsets? Meeting Link? What else?

Pre-Meeting Planning Checklist

☐	Meeting purpose: (subject line)	
☐	Attendees: (names, email addresses, and who should present)	
☐	Link:	
☐	Meeting time and duration:	Time to arrive:
☐	Potential questions:	
☐	Agenda: (create or build together)	Communicate what to bring to meeting:
☐	Preliminary Agenda: Plan activities and set up virtual room: (slides, layouts, pods, file share, web cam, etc.)	
☐	Miscellaneous items:	

Types of Activities to Engage Attendees

Meeting Opener

Conduct an ice-breaker activity when your meeting begins. Works in team meetings where attendees know each other as well as in meetings where attendees don't all know each other or work together regularly.

Objective:

Build a personal connection, create engagement at the start of meeting.

Alternative:

Invite a client or a representative from another department to join the meeting.

Example:

Person of the Day—Give one person (each week during team meeting) the opportunity to share a two-minute story, inspirational lesson, successful project, an update on their work, a new sale made, achievement of a personal or professional goal, or a personal fact little known to the group.

Tools/Features:

- Audio
- PowerPoint slide with person's name/picture (for team activities)
- Web cam (optional)

Notes

Agenda Building

Send planned Agenda with key points out to meeting participants in advance, so they bring the information they need at the meeting, and they know what to expect from the meeting. Then, when the meeting starts, offer the opportunity for attendees to add new items to the agenda. Have anyone with important news add other agenda topics by using a whiteboard or typing in Chat. Reassign time limits and priorities for the meeting, gaining agreement from attendees.

Objective:

Collaborate with attendees to add any new items to the meeting agenda, get attendees engaged from start of meeting, and build buy-in for meeting content.

Tools/Features:

- PowerPoint slide (blank) or whiteboard
- Whiteboard tools: pointer, shapes, pens, colors, etc.
- Chat
- Audio

Notes

Brainstorming

Brainstorming in any meeting is an opportunity to mine ideas from participants in an activity designed to be free of judgment, stated opinion, or a single person dominating the conversation. Virtual meetings allow for the true sense of brainstorming, since it can be anonymous online, and participants may be more willing to offer input. Individual participants can offer ideas quickly in Chats or on a whiteboard. Keep the activity timed and generate as many ideas as possible. Use a “pros” and “cons” list, look for root causes, or explore new product or service features.

Objective:

Generate ideas, gain insight, and gather data to proceed, build buy-in.

Tools/Features:

- PowerPoint slides (Whiteboard tools: text, pointer, highlighters)
- Impromptu Whiteboard
- Poll for voting
- Chat for comments/questions
- Audio

Notes

Technical Tips

- Arrive early and check on everything
- Use an external headset with an inline mute button
- Test all equipment and meeting 'room' functions before starting the meeting
- Close other applications on your computer
- When sharing your screen, share only the pertinent window/application, not the whole desktop
- Change layouts/visuals to keep energy flowing
- Use a countdown timer for activities
- Use a webcam to create a visual connection
- Know your online platform and use it!

Notes

Best Practices for Meetings

- Start and end on time
- Look for signs of boredom from participants; change the action
- Create discussions to drive up the pace and energy
- Mix people into different groups
- Don't mention breaks until you take one
- If participants know it is lunch time or day's end, just stop; attention is lost
- When people get your point, move on; if they haven't, move on and deal with it later
- Keep a sense of urgency for yourself and for the group

Best Practices for Virtual Meetings

- Keep the meeting moving at an energetic pace.
- Encourage an open and casual environment.
- Use software tools to keep people engaged: polls, whiteboard, feedback options, and breakout sessions.
- Change the virtual room layout; create motion
- Do the unexpected; add a quiz, poll, or competition
- Take a break every 60 minutes
- Have your Producer keep a list of topics that are important but should be discussed later or in a different format.

What if you have a different platform?

Features & Platforms	Chat	White-board	Feed-back: Raise Hands/ Status	Webcam	Screen Share	Poling	Breakout Rooms
Webex	X	X	X	X	X	X	Training Center Version
GoToMeeting	X		X	X	X		
GoToWebinar			X	X	X	X	
Skype	X			X	X		
Skype for Business	X	X	X	X	X	X	
Adobe Connect	X	X	X	X	X	X	X

Post-Meeting Follow-Up Worksheet

Post-Meeting Considerations

- Summarize meeting discussions, results, and decisions
- Follow up by email on decisions, action steps, and due dates
- Evaluate the meeting and consider having participants evaluate its value as well
- Devise checkpoints to keep everyone on schedule and focused on results

Results / Decisions		
Action items	Who is responsible?	Due date
Next meeting scheduled:		
Follow-up email sent:		

Summary/Action Plan

The most useful ideas I gained:

Specific actions I will take:

What

When

Organizational impact:

Module 8

How to Build Your Virtual Presence

At the completion of this module, participants will be able to:

- Understand How People View Us
- Identify Communication Factors That Build Trust
- Present To the Webcam
- Utilize Lights, Camera, Backgrounds and Sound
- How to Evaluate a Virtual presenter
- Improve visual and vocal cues
- Create a greater impact on virtual presentations

Preparing Your Virtual Presence



Online Presence



Lighting/Background



Basic Set Up/Camera/Mic

Notes

Four Key Areas to Build Your Virtual Presence:

- Web cam
 - Microphone
 - Lighting
 - Background
-
-
-
-

Creating a Visual Connection – Webcam

1. Look at the webcam, not your screen. Builds Trust with others.
2. Ensure your face is properly centered in the camera
3. Reduce (if possible) any background distractions
4. SMILE!
5. Camera should be eye level



Summary

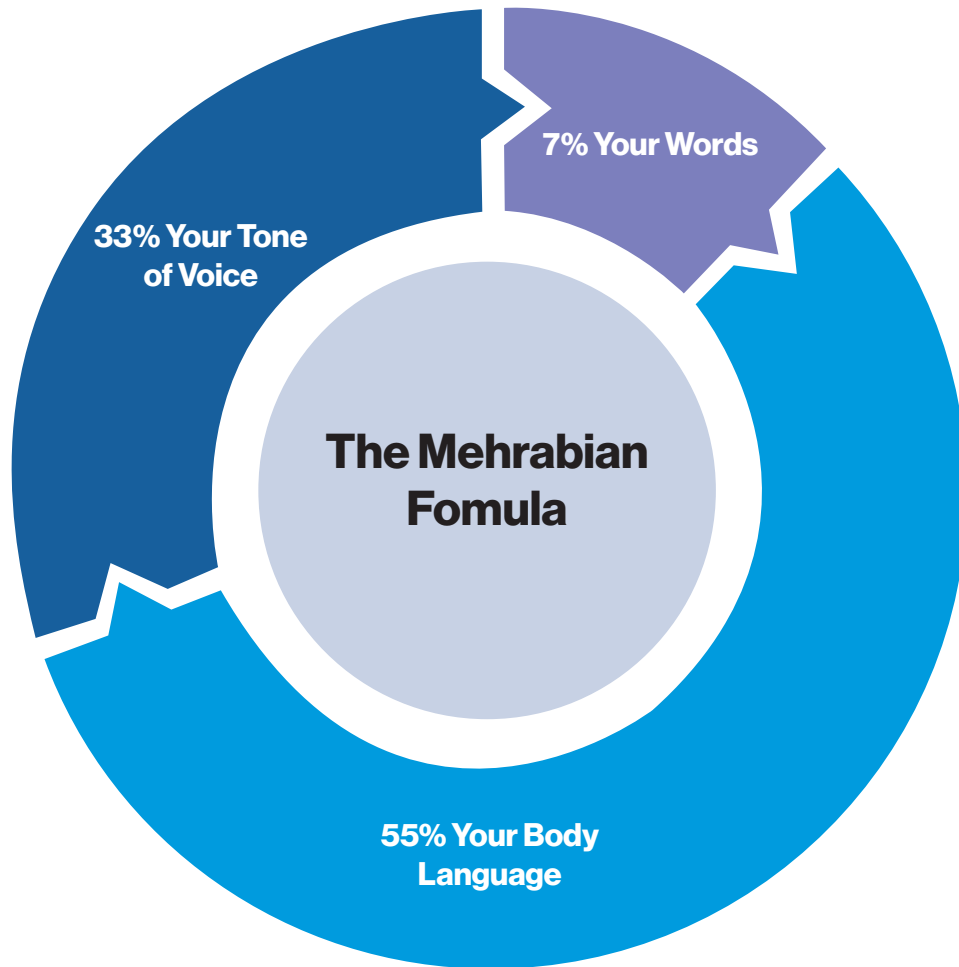
What are your discoveries in this segment?

Why are they important to you and your organization?

What actions will you take moving forward and what will be the benefit of taking those actions?

What are the potential challenges or obstacles you might face? What will you do to overcome the potential challenges?

Building Trust



What are three attributes you would like to convey in the sound of your voice?

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Verbal Cues That Build Trust

☐

Speaks fluently, clearly and is understandable.

☐

Changes the tone and pitch of voice to captivate.

☐

Manages audio distractions; maintains appropriate volume and eliminates background noise.

☐

Uses pauses appropriately and changes pace of speaking.

☐

Speaks with authority in a welcoming voice.

☐

Sounds enthusiastic to be delivering the meeting.

☐

Ensures web cam ready: professional attire, proper lighting, neutral office background, look into camera.

“Real exercise of voice is essential so that distinctness and carrying ability are produced.”

— Dale Carnegie

Visual Cues That Build Trust

Camera-Look at it

Leaning forward 10°-15°

Utilize facial expressions

Body movement

Increase our Energy 20%

Gestures appropriate to the energy

C.L.U.B.I.G is the Cue 

On-Air Presence

☐

Speaks fluently, clearly and is understandable.

☐

Changes the tone and pitch of voice to captivate.

☐

Manages audio distractions; maintains appropriate volume and eliminates background noise.

☐

Uses pauses appropriately and changes pace of speaking.

☐

Speaks with authority in a welcoming voice.

☐

Sounds enthusiastic to be delivering the meeting.

☐

Ensures web cam ready: professional attire, proper lighting, neutral office background, look into camera.

On-Air Presence Practice Notes:



What did you learn about On-Air Presence from this activity?

Guidelines

1. When responding, look directly at the camera
2. Be brief and have a definitive ending
3. Let the other person finish completely - give them space
4. Match or exceed their enthusiasm in your response
5. Utilize body movement, facial expressions & gestures
6. I Love Pizza So Much Because Guidelines!

Summary

What are your discoveries in this segment?

Why are they important to you and your organization?

What actions will you take moving forward and what will be the benefit of taking those actions?

What are the potential challenges or obstacles you might face? What will you do to overcome the potential challenges?

[illegible]

Module 9

Planning Presentations

At the completion of this module, participants will be able to:

- Apply techniques for preparing presentations confidently
- Identify the foundational elements of all presentations
- Analyze the audience and customize delivery for maximum impact
- Choose evidence to support your points

Overview

It doesn't matter what your career is, sooner or later you're going to be responsible for giving presentations. If you are moving up the ladder in your professions, at some point you'll be managing a team, giving project updates, speaking before a management meeting, training clients or colleagues, or giving any number of other professional presentations.

As a professional, you typically spend the first years of your career as a team member performing tasks. As a result, you often get little or no experience giving presentations early in your profession. Then, upon receiving a promotion or being given a wider range of responsibility, you may transition abruptly into giving presentations on a monthly, weekly, or even daily basis.

In this module, the planning process for professional presentations will be explained and discussed. By planning thoroughly and thoughtfully, you can take much of the anxiety out of giving professional presentations and have a powerful impact on your listeners.



“We are interested in a quick and easy way to speak effectively. The only way we can achieve results quickly is to have the right attitude about achieving our goal, and a firm foundation of principles to build on.”

- Dale Carnegie

Presentation Assessment

Recent Presentation

Did I ...	1	2	3	4	5
Know my topic so well I “owned” it?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Have a positive feeling about my topic?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Project the value of my message?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Clearly understand the purpose of my presentation?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Keep my notes limited?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Use visual aids effectively?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Project confidence?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Stay true to myself/authentic?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Focus on my visual impression as well as my content?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Use a friendly tone of voice?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Rehearse the presentation?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Connect with my listeners?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Play myself down, not up?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Recall and use names of my listeners?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Know the level of knowledge/expertise of my listeners?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Take into account biases about this topic?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Talk in terms of my listeners’ interests?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Entertain with examples, showmanship, etc?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Make my ideas clear in a concise manner?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Finish on time, neither significantly early or late?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Challenges and Benefits



This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Attitude Control Principles

Before

- Keep in mind that you are not alone. Most people have some presentation anxiety.
- Remember that people who don't feel some stress may appear to be taking their audience for granted.
- Replace negative thoughts that creep into your subconscious mind with positive affirmations, from yourself and others.
- Don't procrastinate in preparation.
- Have a clear idea of how you will open and close your presentation.

During

- Remember that we usually look and sound better than we think we do.
- Be human and allow yourself to make mistakes.
- Don't try to be the perfect presenter.
- A brief pause to collect your thoughts may feel like eternity, but it's not.
- Tell stories from your personal experiences.
- Have a conversation with people rather than making a presentation to an audience.

After

- Accept and internalize compliments you receive.
- Ask for feedback. You will be surprised how much will be positive.
- Remind yourself about what went well rather than what didn't.
- Focus on one or two key improvement areas for next time. Not ten or twenty.

Presentation Guidelines

Presentation Fundamentals

1. Know your material so well, you feel you own it.
2. Have a positive feeling about the subject you are about to present.
3. Project to your audience the value and significance of your message.

Presentation Guidelines

1. Make brief notes of the interesting things you want to mention.
(consider 3 x 5 cards or “stacking technique.”) Be human and allow yourself to make mistakes.
2. Prepare well in advance.
3. Unless absolutely necessary (for legal reasons, etc.), don’t write out your talk.
4. Never memorize a talk word-for-word.
5. Use evidence to substantiate your points.
6. Know far more about your subject than you can use.
7. Use visual aids when appropriate.
8. Control “butterflies” with:
 - A few deep breaths
 - Pep talks and “success cards”
 - Physical activity
9. Research your subject and audience.

Presentation Guidelines (continued)

Build Rapport

1. Consider yourself honored by being asked to address an audience—and say so!
2. Give your listeners sincere appreciation.
3. Mention the names of some listeners.
4. Play yourself down, not up!
5. Don't talk with "a scowling face and an upbraiding voice."
6. Talk in terms of your listeners' interests.
7. Have a good time making your talk.
8. Appeal to the nobler emotions of your audience.
9. Welcome criticism instead of resenting it.

Types of Presentations

1	2	3	4
Inform	Convince	Persuade	Inspire

Inform:

Convince:

Persuade:

Inspire:

Create Impact



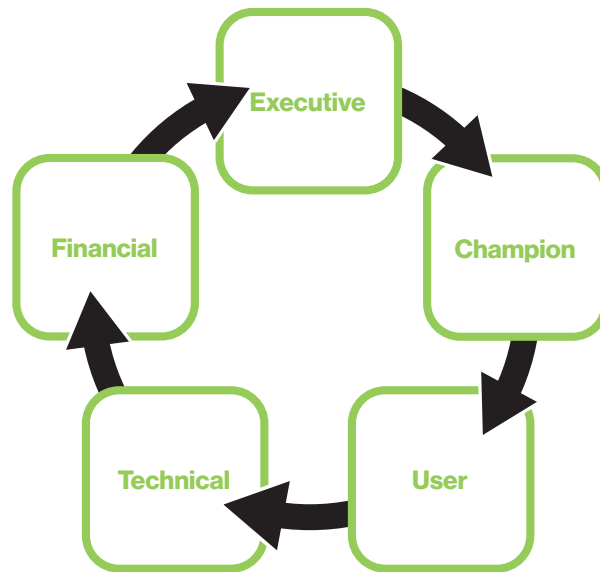
Basic Presentation Structure

Opening — Begin in a friendly way to gain favorable attention.

Message — Ensure the main part of the presentation has a clear message. Use evidence as appropriate to add credibility.

Closing — Leave a lasting favorable impression of both the message and yourself.

Audience Analysis: Functional Influences



Executive:

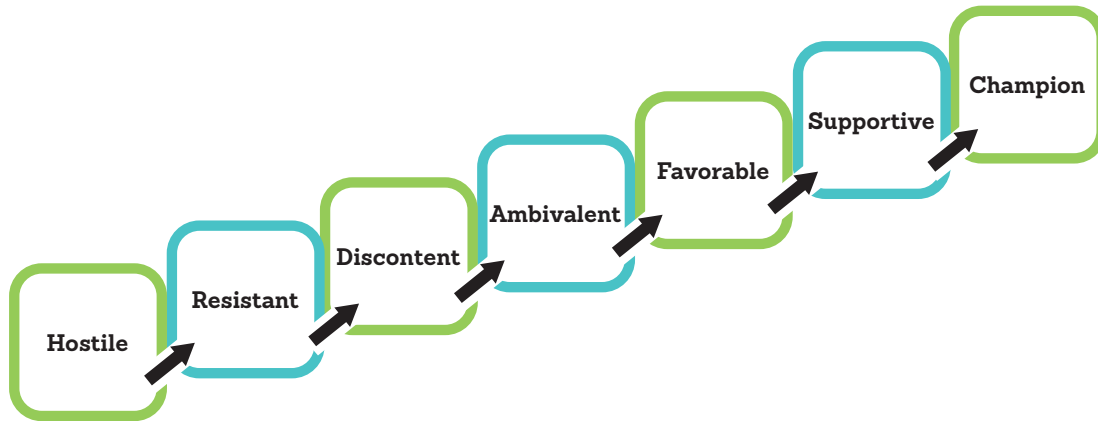
Technical:

Financial:

User:

Champion:

Audience Analysis: Attitude Influences



Notes

[illegible]

Audience Analysis: Knowledge Influences



Notes

[illegible]

Presentation to Inform: Example

Opening

Topic: “We’re meeting today to discuss the new e-mail software implementation.”

Message

State Key Message: Desired End Result

“The IT Department has set up a telephone helpline and an online start-up guide to help you get oriented to our new system.”

- **Point One:** “To access the telephone hotline, press *11 on your internal phone.”
 - Result:** “You can talk to a technical expert.”
- **Point Two:** “To access the online instructions, log on to the IT homepage.”
 - Result:** “This page covers all of the added features of our new e-mail system.”
- **Point Three:** “Click on the “Updates” tab on your homepage.”
 - Result:** “All of the start-up instructions are there for you to follow.”

Closing

Restate Key Message: Desired End Result

“Again, the IT Department has set up both a telephone hotline and an online installation guide for our new e-mail system. Using these resources will enable you to easily and quickly get the new system running smoothly.”

Presentation Planning Template

Audience: _____	Topic: _____
Contact Info: _____	Location: _____
Date: _____	Start/Finish Time: _____
Size of Audience: _____	Q & A: _____
Introducer: _____	Dress Code: _____
Visual Support: _____	Sound Support: _____
Other Presenters: _____	

Preparation

Purpose:

Key Stakeholders:

Research Sources:

Audience Analysis:

Presentation Planning Template (continuation)

Outline

Opening:

Key Point #1

Key Point #2

Key Point #3

Closing:

Tips: Using Flip Charts, White Boards, and Exhibits

1. Prepare some flip charts before the event.
2. Write notes in light pencil on flip charts to remind you of key points.
3. Put a fold or post-it on these pages if you want to find them easily.
4. Create professional wall charts for concepts referenced frequently.
5. When capturing audience contributions, paraphrase into 1–2 key words.
6. Write a bit more slowly so you are clear and legible.
7. Ask volunteers to write ideas on the board while you facilitate.
8. Don't reveal concepts until you are ready to discuss them.
9. Turn to an empty page when you are done with a topic.
10. Be accurate with spelling. Have participants correct you if needed.
11. Use a white board for most writing. Use flip charts for concepts you will refer to later.
12. Be careful to use dry-erase markers only for white boards. Check carefully.
13. Use different colors to clarify key points, black, green, and blue. Avoid the color red.
14. When using exhibits, talk to the audience instead of looking at the exhibit.
15. Display exhibits only when you are ready to use them, hold them so people can see, and put them away when you are done.

Tips on Power Point

Design

1. Follow the 6 x 6 rule: six words per line, six lines per visual.
2. Follow the 10-Second rule: people should be able to understand a visual in ten seconds.
3. Use large font: 44 for titles, 32 for text, use Arial or Times New Roman.
4. Use graphics and photos, not just text.
5. Keep transitions simple and consistent.
Use builds (animation) to reveal information as needed.

Delivery

1. Never read word-for-word from the screen. Know your material so well you don't have to read it. Paraphrase instead of reading out loud.
2. Keep eye contact with the audience. Don't turn your back to the audience to look at the screen. Use your computer monitor or printed copy of the visuals (6 per page) as a reference if needed.
3. Turn off the projector or show a black slide when you are not using it.
4. Retain the power position, at the front center of the room.
5. Check the room for lines of sight, turn off or disable some lights.
6. Be ready to conduct your event even if the power fails.

Remember: you are the presentation. Don't let PowerPoint become the presentation.

Tips for Presenting

1. Be conversational.
2. Avoid jargon and words that may be unfamiliar to the audience. Translate language into their world.
3. Maintain eye contact with participants, including those seated beyond the first few rows.
4. Be aware of your “default” facial expression. When you are thinking, do you have a tendency to frown, look up, or look away?
5. Studies have shown that people want to see the palms of our hands during presentations. Hands held behind the back or in the fig leaf position may detract from the message or send a conflicting message.
6. Use your full range of tools in delivery: vocal variety, facial expressions, expressive gestures, and purposeful movement.
7. Project your voice in a strong clear tone, conversational and appropriate for the size of the room and seating arrangement.
8. Avoid speaking in a monotone. Vocal variety can be accomplished by raising and lowering pitch and adjusting the rate of speech.
9. Link gestures and words for congruency. If you say an object is large, demonstrate through gestures just how large. If you say you are excited, your facial expression and eyes should convey the same excitement.
10. When giving directions (like small group discussion or practice), give clear brief instructions before moving people into action.
11. Avoid pacing. Make your movement purposeful.
12. Don't get trapped behind a lectern.
13. Have water available.
14. Use voice projection (wireless lavalier microphone) when appropriate.
15. Dress slightly above the level of audience.
16. Visit the room the day before you deliver.

Don't be a presenter. Be what Quintillan called “a good person skilled in speaking.”

Summary

The two most useful ideas I gained:

1. _____

2. _____

Application opportunities:

Specific actions I will take:

Organizational impact:

[illegible]

Module 10

How to Present Virtual Solutions with Impact

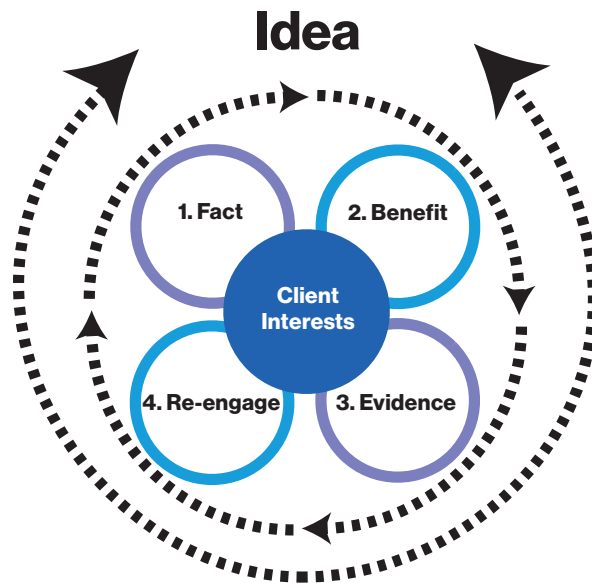
At the completion of this module participants will be able to:

1. Make ideas clear and concise for greater understanding
2. Walk through recommendations using a framework that maximizes buy-in
3. Increase customer engagement through presentation structure and deliver
4. Utilize evidence to enhance compelling solutions.

Presenting an Idea

What is the Idea?

The way we position our ideas is almost as important as the idea itself. Unfortunately, sometimes people have no position or at least no compelling explanations for their ideas. Know what your ideas are and why they matter to your customers and keep it in mind throughout the preparation so that the dialogue stays on track.



Try honestly to see things from the other person's point of view.

Specific Customer : _____

Idea: _____

Fact—What It Is

Our idea should be explained one point at a time. Each fact should support the idea and should be relevant to our audience.

Examples:

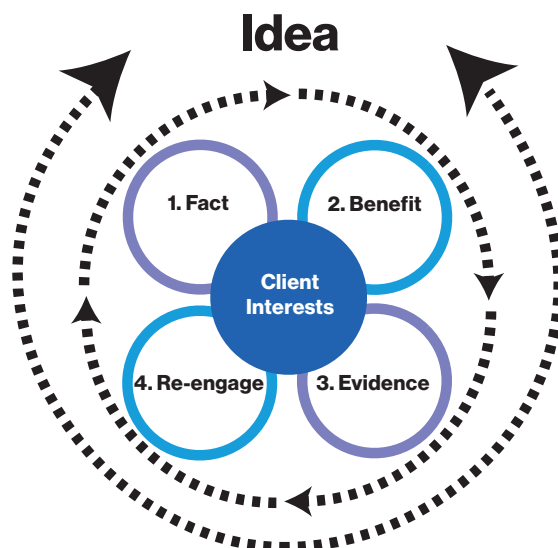
1. *Electronic performance management systems are a key tool for retaining top talent.*
2. *This system helps us better understand talent and talent needs.*
3. *We provide a lens into the healthcare delivery system with a broad view across tens of millions of patients and their data.*
4. *This system helps us understand our populations better.*

Fact 1: _____

Fact 2: _____

Fact 3: _____

Fact 4, 5, 6...



Benefit—What It Will Do for This Customer

The Benefit step is an explanation that clarifies specifically how the customer will apply the fact to their particular primary interest(s) and personal interest(s).

Examples:

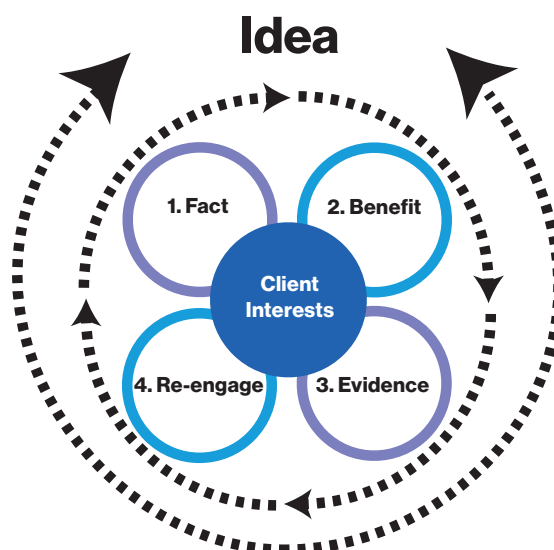
1. *You mentioned that you're concerned about turnover in your department.*
2. *Being able to more clearly see who can take on more responsibility is a key issue for you and this electronic system v. paper is an easier way to do that.*

Benefit 1: _____

Benefit 2: _____

Benefit 3: _____

Benefit 4, 5, 6 ...



Evidence DEFEATS Doubt

D	Demonstration
E	Example
F	Fact
E	Exhibit
A	Analogy
T	Testimonial
S	Statistic

Evidence Examples:

1. Demonstration: An illustration using a physical demonstration with a prop or possibly the solution itself.
2. Example: A story about a satisfied customer.
3. Fact: Statement of truth that supports the point you are making.
4. Exhibit: Something physical that supports your solution; something the person can see, touch, hear, smell, or taste.
5. Analogy: A comparison of your solution to something with which the person is already familiar.
6. Testimonial: An acknowledgment of your solution's capabilities, in spoken or other form, from someone who has used that solution.
7. Statistic: Accurate and relevant numbers that support your solutions.

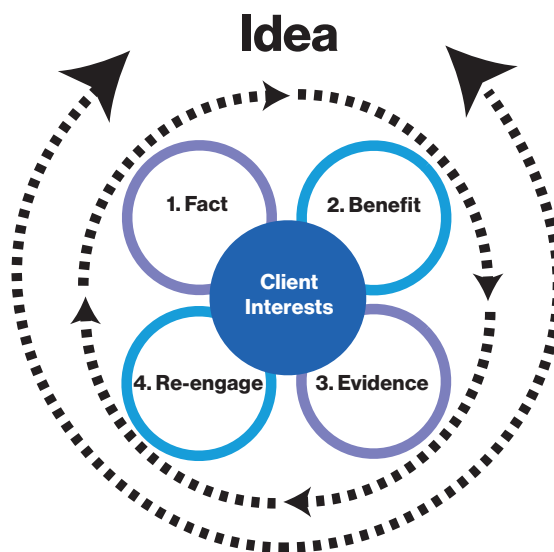
Evidence DEFEATS Doubt

Evidence 1: _____

Evidence 2: _____

Evidence 3: _____

Evidence 4, 5, 6 ...



Re-Engage

The re-engage question asks for an opinion not a decision. We are collaborating with the buyer to contemplate using the information you just shared. This is a non threatening questions which allows the client to share a reaction with you to the idea you brought up. The reaction to the re-engage question helps clarify the clients position to either accept or reject the idea presented and allows them to stay engaged during the process.

Examples:

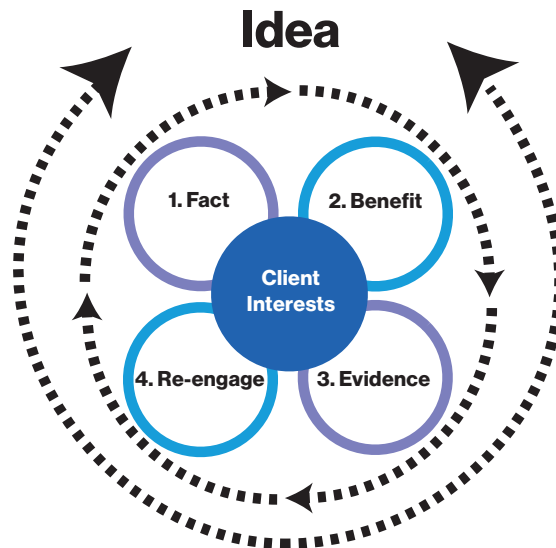
1. *How will that impact your team?*
2. *How will that (Benefit) drive the change you are looking for?*
3. *How do you see that fitting in?*
4. *What will that do to help your team?*

Re-engage question 1: _____

Re-engage question 2: _____

Re-engage question 3: _____

Re-engage question 4, 5, 6 ...



Example

Customer	Example
Need	<i>An electronic performance management system will more effectively manage talent.</i>
Fact	<i>The first step of engaging leaders is to walk through the current gaps of the paper system.</i>
Benefit	<i>This will foster buy in to more easily implement the new system.</i>
Evidence	<i>Companies that use these systems see results. For example, another company like ours says it's seen measurable improvements after managers began giving constructive feedback that was forward-looking, instead of reviewing what had happened in the past.</i>
Re-engage	<i>How do you think this will help your team?</i>

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Practice

Customer		
Need		
Fact		
Benefit		
Evidence	D E F E A T S	D E F E A T S
Re-engage		

Evidence for Each Perspective

Choose which evidence to use depending on the type of buyer.

Financial Buyer:

Executive Buyer:

User Buyer:

Technical Buyer:

Trial Commitment

A trial commitment is a question that asks for an opinion, not a buying decision. Use a non-threatening question to test the customer's reaction to a specific aspect of the solution. The reaction to the trial commitment question helps clarify the customer's position regarding acceptance of what was just presented.

- *How does that look to you?*
- *Does this sound like what you're looking for?*
- *What are your thoughts about this now?*

- ---
- ---
- ---

Customized Power Solution 1

Customer: _____

Primary Interest: _____

Buying Perspective: _____

1. Need: _____

Fact: _____

Benefit: _____

Re-engage: _____

2. Need: _____

Fact: _____

Benefit: _____

Re-engage: _____

3. Need: _____

Fact: _____

Benefit: _____

Re-engage-: _____

Evidence:

Trial Commitment:

Customized Power Solution 2

Customer: _____

Primary Interest: _____

Buying Perspective: _____

1. Need: _____

Fact: _____

Benefit: _____

Re-engage: _____

2. Need: _____

Fact: _____

Benefit: _____

Re-engage: _____

3. Need: _____

Fact: _____

Benefit: _____

Re-engage: _____

Evidence:

Trial Commitment:

Summary

What are your discoveries in this segment?

Why are they important to you and your organization?

What actions will you take moving forward and what will be the benefit of taking those actions?

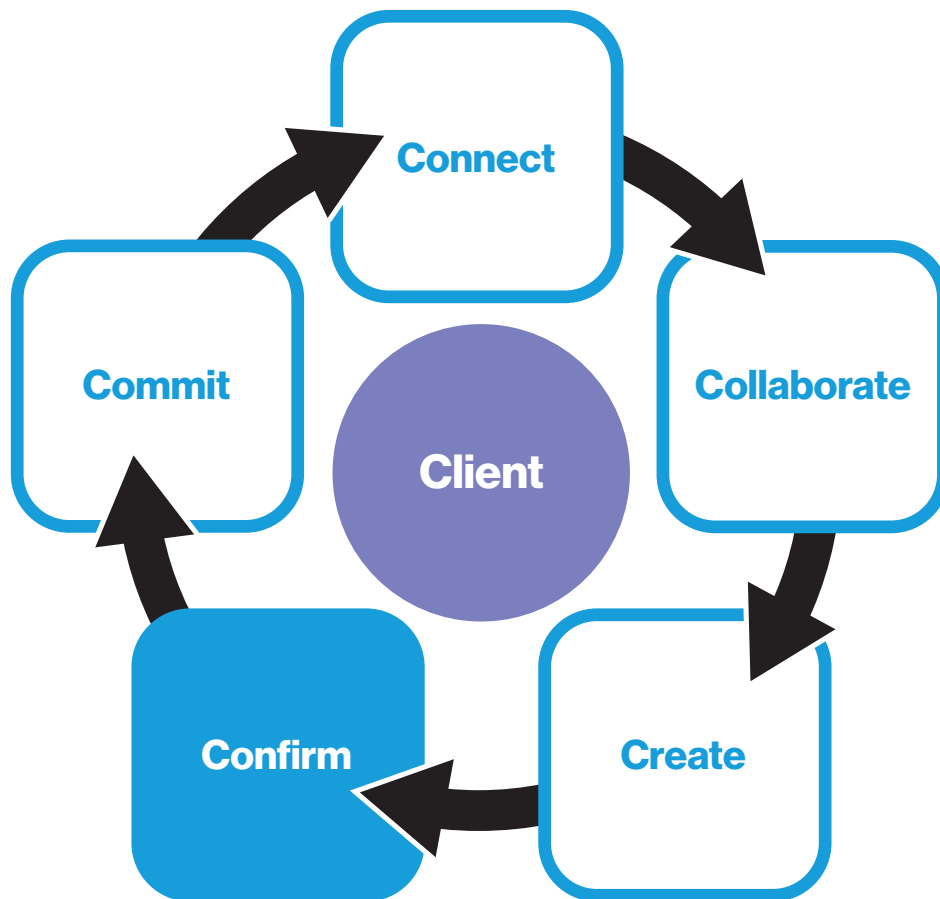
What are the potential challenges or obstacles you might face? What will you do to overcome the potential challenges?

[illegible]

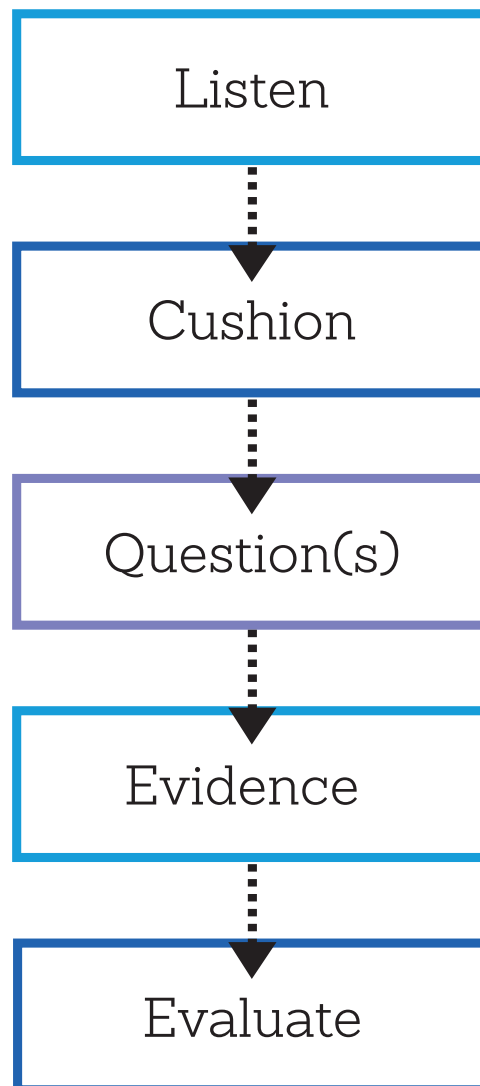
Handle Objections with Ease

At the completion of this module, participants will be able to:

- Apply a win-win process to resolve objections
- Identify points of agreement to lower buyer resistance
- Respond to your most common objections with confidence



Structure for Resolving Objections



Step 1 : Listen for Understanding

It can be a real challenge to really listen to objections. Most salespeople face the same handful of objections, and we tend to hear them all the time. We generally think we know what the buyer is going to say, and we often know how we will respond. This creates a tendency to listen halfway through and jump in to respond. This is an important time to slow down the sales process, listen for understanding, and see objections from the buyer's point of view.



Step 2: Cushion for Empathy

A cushion is a statement that acknowledges that we listened to the prospect, heard the objection, and recognized its importance. When a buyer states an objection, our first action should be to cushion the objection. A cushion does not agree, disagree, or answer the objection.

Examples of Cushions:

The specific wording of your cushion may vary depending on the relationship you already have with the client or prospect, and on the region or country you are in. These examples demonstrate the concept of cushioning, but may require editing depending on these factors.

Objection That's more expensive than I was expecting.

Cushion Oh, that's a shame to hear. You'd want to be comfortable with any budget you set

Objection Why do I have to pay for every click, not just when job seekers apply?!?

Cushion When I first learned about pay for performance pricing, I asked the same thing.

Objection There's nothing you've said that makes me think you are better than my current supplier.

Cushion I get you—if you're going to consider changing suppliers, there has to be a compelling reason.

Objection Thanks for the demo, I'll get back to you if ever I think of needing you.

Cushion Thank you for your time as well, I know how busy you are.

Objection You don't have the specific job seekers that I'm looking for.

Cushion The roles you're looking to fill are certainly highly specialized.

Step 3: Question to Clarify

In the resolving objections process, asking open-ended questions serves at least five purposes:

1. The objection becomes a dialog or conversation, rather than a battle,
2. We demonstrate that we're not overly eager to rebut the client's views,
3. We increase our own understanding of the root cause of the objection,
4. We may help the client talk themselves out of the objection he/she presented,
5. We buy ourselves time to respond with evidence.

Conversely, asking multiple close-ended questions (questions that can be answered with one word) not only shuts down the conversation, they may make clients feel as though we are attempting to manipulate them, by trapping them with narrow questions.

Open-ended questions tend to start with Why, How, What, or Tell me more about ...

Close-ended questions tend to start with Did you, Will you, Can I, or How many ...

Examples of Questions:

Objection I'm already getting good results from your organic traffic.

Cushion Good to hear that our free service is providing results already.

Questions Tell me a little about the quality of applicants coming through?
Help me understand, when you say "good", what does that look like?

Objection I've filled the positions I was advertising, so I want to pause my campaign.

Cushion Absolutely, you have the flexibility to do that.

Questions So that I can make the right recommendations, help me understand what some of your recruitment plans are in the business for the next 3–6 months?

So we're doing this correctly, take me back to your overall recruitment strategy—how did these roles fit in to the larger growth plans of the company?

Step 4 : Provide Evidence to Convince

We only have a chance of overcoming objections if we are able to provide a strong rationale for our point of view. In step four: Evidence, we offer new information, building a compelling case for the client to potentially see things differently. We may draw upon any of these forms of evidence:

D	Demonstration Demonstrate how your software works
E	Example Provide an example of where you have helped other clients
F	Fact A statement of truth that supports the point you are making
E	Exhibit Show the client an exhibit of results achieved
A	Analogy Remove complexity by simplifying your point with an analogy
T	Testimonial Discuss a client case study where results have been achieved
S	Statistics Draw upon data to build a compelling case

Step 5 : Evaluate

We may think that we have done a terrific job of resolving the buyer's objection. However, it is what the buyer feels that is important. Before moving ahead, let's take a moment to evaluate whether or not the buyer is ready to move forward toward a commitment.

Examples:

Does that make you feel more comfortable about the investment?

How does that sound?

What are your thoughts?

Planning Objection Responses

Objection	Cushion

Clarifying Questions	Persuasive Evidence (DEFEATS)

Summary

What are your discoveries in this segment?

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[illegible]